

Ankit Raj

Senior Solution Architect - Identity & Access Management, Zero Trust & Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Solution Architect with 10+ years designing secure, scalable solutions across large-scale, distributed system-of-systems environments. I lead through collaboration and clarity - aligning enterprise, security, platform, and product teams around a shared identity and Zero Trust architecture. Hands-on experience defining reference architectures and capability models, and translating security standards such as ISO, NIST, and OWASP into practical, reusable architectural guidelines. Proven in identity-centric security: Zero Trust microservices, RBAC and policy governance at enterprise scale (1,600+ subscriptions), and an IAM modernisation migrating from Curity to a cloud-native identity platform. Comfortable connecting strategy with execution in SAFe and scaled-agile contexts - facilitating architecture forums, design reviews, and technical decisions that balance security, compliance, and business needs. A clear communicator who engages both technical and business stakeholders, and a genuine believer in reuse, standardisation, and lifting the people around me.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Identity & Access Management	IAM Reference Architecture, Capability Modelling, Entra ID, AWS Cognito, Curity, OAuth 2.0 / OIDC, RBAC, Identity Federation, Identity Lifecycle, Privileged Access
Zero Trust & Security	Zero Trust Architecture, Identity-Centric Security, Least Privilege, Microsegmentation, Azure Sentinel, Key Vault, Secure DevOps
Standards & Frameworks	ISO 27001, NIST CSF, OWASP, CAF, Well-Architected Framework (WAF), TOGAF, Zachman, SAP LeanIX
Solution & System Architecture	Large-Scale Distributed Systems, System-of-Systems, Reference Architecture, Design Reviews, Architecture Forums, Standardisation & Reuse
Ways of Working	SAFe / Scaled Agile, Cross-ART Alignment, Stakeholder Facilitation, Risk & Compliance Collaboration, Technical Decision-Making
Cloud & Platforms	Microsoft Azure, AWS, Google Cloud - Architecture, Migration & Governance, Landing Zones, Azure Policy
Infrastructure & DevOps	Terraform, Bicep, Kubernetes (AKS), Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Observability (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus)
Languages	TypeScript, Python, JavaScript, Go, SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Cloud Architect - Security, Identity & Multi-Cloud Governance2024 - Present

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Lead and align architecture across teams and ARTs in a SAFe context - facilitating architecture forums, design reviews, and technical decisions that connect long-term strategy with day-to-day execution for 200+ product teams
- Defined and evolved enterprise governance and identity reference architecture - RBAC, security baselines, Azure Policy, and landing zones enforcing least-privilege access across 1,600+ subscriptions in a system-of-systems estate
- Translate security standards such as ISO 27001, NIST, and OWASP into practical, reusable architectural guidelines, driving Zero Trust and identity-centric security across a complex multi-cloud landscape
- Promote reuse, standardisation, and shared capabilities - publishing architecture blueprints, capability models, and best-practice patterns adopted across enterprise, security, and platform teams
- Balance security, compliance, and business needs as a trusted advisor to executive stakeholders, collaborating closely with risk, compliance, platform, and product teams
- Built multi-agent AI workflows (MCP tools + RAG) for incident response and security governance using Microsoft Foundry and GCP Vertex AI, strengthening proactive security posture
- Mentored and upskilled 8+ engineers through workshops and design exercises, leading through collaboration, clarity, and direction

Lead Software Engineer - Azure Engineering & Cloud Governance2023 - 2024

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Engineered the cloud backbone on Azure & Google Cloud and led cloud governance with Azure Policy and Microsoft Sentinel - embedding identity, security, and compliance controls into the platform by default
- Led enterprise architecture using SAP LeanIX, Zachman, and TOGAF - maintaining the capability model and reference architecture that aligned technology decisions with long-term business strategy
- Designed and built an Internal Developer Platform with self-service provisioning (EventGrid + Azure Functions) - standardising secure, golden-path infrastructure and reducing onboarding from days to minutes
- Evaluated and benchmarked OpenAI, Claude, and Gemini LLMs for developer experience, shipping productivity solutions that improved team velocity by 40%
- Facilitated cross-team design reviews and Well-Architected Reviews, creating reusable patterns and shared capabilities for adoption across ARTs

Senior Software Engineer - Zero Trust & Distributed Systems2020 - 2023

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Designed a Zero Trust microservices architecture - 15+ services with identity-aware access and sub-100ms p99 latency, demonstrating deep security, infrastructure, and networking expertise
- Built a multi-cloud API platform with Azure API Gateways on GKE - high-throughput GraphQL & REST APIs (50K+ RPM) with authentication, authorisation, and rate limiting enforced at the edge
- Led CI/CD standardisation with GitHub Actions across 200+ repositories - 95% pipeline success rate, embedding secure-by-default DevOps practices at enterprise scale
- Resolved complex cross-system technical blockers through root-cause analysis, improving reliability and developer experience across the distributed landscape

Cloud Solution Architect Consultant - IAM Modernisation (AML/KYC)2019 - 2020

Cognizant - Ikano Bank, Stockholm

- Architected an identity and API modernisation, migrating AML & KYC APIs from an on-premises Axway gateway to a cloud-native serverless platform - reducing latency by 70% and improving resilience
- Led the identity migration from Curity to AWS Cognito - redesigning authentication, authorisation, and token flows (OAuth 2.0 / OIDC) for regulated financial workloads handling 500K+ daily transactions
- Established governance and least-privilege access with AWS Organisations and IAM policies - separating billing, security, and workload boundaries with Terraform IaC
- Delivered proof-of-concept demonstrations to executive stakeholders, building alignment and consensus for cloud and identity adoption
- Implemented CloudWatch observability and GitHub Actions CI/CD, replacing manual deployments with secure, repeatable pipelines

Volvo Cars, Gothenburg

- Trusted technical advisor to engineering teams - designed and delivered an enterprise observability platform (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus) on AKS monitoring 100+ automotive microservices
- Managed CI/CD pipelines for OpenShift & Kubernetes clusters with Azure DevOps - reducing deployment cycle time from hours to 15 minutes
- Authored architecture documentation, runbooks, and incident response procedures - achieving 99.5% SLA compliance across production environments
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to translate automotive requirements into optimised, secure cloud solutions

Cloud DevOps Engineer → Cloud Developer

Cognizant Technology Solutions

- Designed AWS cloud architectures for 5+ enterprise clients - CI/CD with CodePipeline, Docker, and ECS/Fargate across diverse industry verticals
- Automated resource tagging and policy governance across AWS & Azure using Config Rules, Azure Policy, and Lambda - establishing identity and compliance guardrails at scale
- Built a React-based Cloud Management Dashboard providing real-time infrastructure visibility and cost analytics to enterprise customers
- Won 1st place at Enterprise AWS Game Day 2018 (200+ participants), and provided technical guidance and knowledge transfer to client teams

KEY SOLUTIONS & ARCHITECTURE PROJECTS

IAM Modernisation - Curity to Cognito Migration (Ikano Bank)

Re-architected identity for regulated AML/KYC workloads - migrated from Curity to AWS Cognito with redesigned OAuth 2.0 / OIDC flows, IAM least-privilege boundaries, and AWS Organisations governance. Terraform IaC, 70% latency reduction.

Enterprise Governance & Zero Trust at Scale (H&M Group)

Defined RBAC, security baselines, and Azure Policy enforcing least-privilege across 1,600+ subscriptions. Microsoft Sentinel for detection, landing zones for isolation - aligned to ISO, NIST, and CAF/WAF principles.

Zero Trust Microservices Platform (H&M Group)

Identity-aware GraphQL & REST API platform - 15+ services with edge authentication/authorisation via Azure API Gateways on GKE, sub-100ms p99 latency and enforced least privilege.

OpenClaw Tesla - Identity-Secured AI Agent (Open Source)

AI agent plugin for the Tesla Fleet API with 21 voice-controlled actions, secured end-to-end with OAuth 2.0. Demonstrates identity integration, token management, and secure agent orchestration. TypeScript.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional**
- **AWS Certified Developer - Associate**
- **Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) - Exam 533: Azure Infrastructure**
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)**
- Microsoft OpenHack: Security, Compliance & Identity · AI-Powered Knowledge Mining · Containers · DevOps
- Google India Udacity Scholar

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Computer Science & Engineering

Galgotias University, Greater Noida, India

Specialisation in Cloud Computing & Virtualisation. Projects: IoT Heart Rate Monitor, Big Data Analytics.

PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

I Gave an AI Agent Root Access to a Sandboxed Linux Box - AI agent security & sandboxing experiment (Medium)

Why FinOps Is Failing the Enterprise - Enterprise cloud cost governance (Medium)

What is Kubernetes? - Container orchestration deep-dive (FAUN / Medium)

Azure DevOps is the new VSTS - Enterprise DevOps transformation (Medium)